Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Sarkaria Commission and Punchhi Commission

Indian Government & Politics · Unit 2 · Chapter Sarkaria Commission and Punchhi Commission

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

Chapter Study Notes

Learning focus

The Sarkaria Commission was established in 1983 to examine Union–State relations and submitted its report in 1988.

1. Its recommendations emphasised consultation, cooperative federalism, careful use of Article 356 and conventions governing the appointment and conduct of governors.

2. The Punchhi Commission was constituted in 2007 and reported in 2010. It revisited federal relations, governors, emergency provisions, internal security and intergovernmental coordination.

3. Both commissions sought to improve constitutional practice and reduce avoidable conflict between levels of government.

4. A comparison should identify the shared aim of balanced federalism while noting the different political and administrative contexts in which the commissions worked.

Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?